
THE EXACT PROMPT · FOR CLAUDE · 2026

The 90-Second Account Breakdown

The exact Claude prompt that turns any Instagram account's post data into ranked patterns, broken-down hooks, and fresh content ideas in your own voice — not a copy of theirs.

1

structured prompt does
the actual analysis

15-40

posts is the sweet spot
for a reliable read

3

honest ways to get the
data — Section 01

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Reverse-engineering, not copying

The distinction matters enough to state plainly before anything else: this workflow is for understanding why content works — the hook style, the format, the topic angle, the posting rhythm — never for taking someone else's captions, scripts or ideas and reposting them as your own. One is competitive research, a completely normal and legitimate practice. The other is plagiarism, and it also just produces worse content, because it's missing your actual voice and expertise.

What you're actually extracting is structural: which hook types this audience responds to, which formats outperform others on this account, what topics repeat in their best posts. That structure then gets applied to your own ideas, your own niche, your own way of saying things.

WHAT THIS DOCUMENT IS

The exact analysis prompt, the data format it needs, a second prompt that turns the analysis into fresh ideas in your voice, and three honest options for actually getting the data — including which ones are fully compliant with Instagram's rules and which carry real trade-offs.

How to use it

- 01** Pick one account in or near your niche — ideally one that's clearly performing well, not just one you personally like.
- 02** Get its post data using one of the three methods in Section 01.
- 03** Format it using the template in Section 02.
- 04** Run the analysis prompt in Section 03.
- 05** Run the ideation prompt in Section 04 to turn the analysis into ideas for your own account.

Getting the data — three honest options

This is the part every version of this workflow glosses over. Instagram does not hand out detailed performance data on other people's accounts for free, and the three real routes to it have genuinely different trade-offs worth knowing before you pick one.

Method	Gives you	Trade-off
Manual collection	Everything visible in-app: views, likes, comments, caption, post date, format — for any public account	Free and fully compliant. Slow — realistically 15-20 minutes for 20-30 posts
Business Discovery API	Official, Meta-sanctioned access to another Business/Creator account's recent posts: likes and comments, follower/media counts	No view counts on reels through this route. Requires a Business/Creator account and a Meta developer app to query with
Third-party analytics tools	Fast, often includes view estimates and posting-time patterns across many accounts at once	Paid, varies by tool. These operate outside Instagram's own API — check each tool's current terms before relying on one for client work

Which one to actually use

- Analysing one or two accounts occasionally? Manual collection is genuinely fine. Open their grid, scroll their last 20-30 posts, note the numbers in a sheet as you go.
- Need comment and like data at scale, staying fully within Instagram's own rules? The Business Discovery API is the correct route — it just won't give you view counts, and needs a one-time developer setup.
- Doing this weekly, or as a paid service for clients? A third-party analytics or scraping tool is what most agencies actually reach for, because manual collection doesn't scale. Go in aware this sits outside Instagram's own terms, and treat it as a business decision, not a purely technical one.

The prompt in Section 03 doesn't care which method fed it. It works from a data table — the source of that table is a separate decision from the analysis itself.

This is general guidance, not legal advice. Data collection and automated-access terms are set by Instagram and change over time — check current terms before building a workflow that depends on any one method at volume.

Structuring the data

Whichever method you used, get it into this shape before it goes anywhere near Claude. A clean table is what makes the analysis prompt actually work well — a wall of pasted captions does not.

DATA TEMPLATE — SAVE AS CSV OR A SIMPLE TABLE

```
post_date, format, hook_first_line, topic, likes, comments, views
2026-07-02, reel, "Nobody tells you this about...", pricing, 12400, 340, 89000
2026-07-05, carousel, "3 mistakes killing your...", mistakes, 8900, 210, -
2026-07-09, reel, "POV: your client just said...", client-story, 21000, 560, 145000
...
```

What each column is for

- hook_first_line — the exact opening line or on-screen text, verbatim. This is what the pattern analysis actually runs on, so accuracy here matters more than any other column.
- format — reel, carousel, single image, story highlight. Keep this consistent so the prompt can group by it reliably.
- topic — your own one-or-two-word tag for what the post is actually about. You're adding this by hand; it's what lets the analysis find topic patterns, not just hook patterns.
- views — leave it as a dash or blank if your data source doesn't have it (see Section 01) rather than guessing. The prompt is built to handle gaps honestly.

How many posts

15 posts is the practical minimum for a pattern to mean anything. 20-40 is the sweet spot — enough to separate a real pattern from a lucky post, without so much that you spend longer formatting data than you save on ideation.

The analysis prompt

This is the one from the reel. Paste your data table directly below it in the same message.

PROMPT

You are a content strategist analysing performance data to find patterns, not to summarise the account.

Below is post data from an Instagram account in the [YOUR NICHE] space. Columns: post_date, format, hook_first_line, topic, likes, comments, views (some views may be missing - that's expected, work with what's there).

[PASTE YOUR DATA TABLE HERE]

Do the following, in order:

1. RANK the posts by performance. Where views exist, weight views highest; where they don't, use comments-to-likes ratio as a proxy for genuine engagement over passive likes. Show your top 5 and bottom 5.
2. IDENTIFY PATTERNS across the top performers specifically - not the account overall. Break down:
 - Hook patterns: what type of opening line repeats in the top 5? (question, contrarian claim, specific number, story open, direct callout - name the actual pattern, don't just describe each one individually)
 - Format patterns: which format dominates the top performers?
 - Topic patterns: which 1-2 topics show up disproportionately in the top half versus the bottom half?
 - Timing patterns: any visible pattern in post_date - day of week, frequency, gaps before a strong post?
3. NAME what's NOT working. Be specific about the bottom performers - what pattern do THEY share? This is usually more useful than the top-performer analysis and most people skip it.
4. Give me a one-paragraph summary of this account's actual content strategy, stated as if you were explaining it to someone who has never seen the account.

Rules:

- Base every claim on the data provided. If you notice something interesting but the sample is too small to be confident, say so explicitly rather than presenting a guess as a finding.
- Do not evaluate whether the content is 'good' - only what correlates with performance in this specific data.
- Quote the actual hook lines when describing a pattern, don't paraphrase them.

Turning it into your own content

Run this as the next message in the same conversation, right after the analysis above. This is the step that actually makes it yours instead of a copy.

PROMPT

Now use those patterns to generate content ideas for MY account - not this one.

My niche: [YOUR NICHE]

My angle / point of view: [WHAT YOU BELIEVE THAT'S YOURS - see note below if you're not sure]

My audience: [WHO]

Tone: [YOUR TONE - e.g. Hinglish, direct, no-hype]

Give me 15 content ideas that apply the WORKING patterns you just identified to my niche and my angle. For each idea:

- The hook, written in my voice and language, not theirs
- The format (matching what you found actually performs)
- The core idea in one line
- Which pattern from the analysis this is built on

Rules:

- Apply the STRUCTURE (hook type, format, topic category, timing), never the specific words, examples, or stories from the original account. If an idea is too close to a specific post you analysed, rewrite it or drop it.
- Every idea must reflect something true about my actual business or expertise - don't invent a story, result, or credential for me.
- Mark the 3 ideas you think are strongest and say why, specific to my audience, not just 'this pattern performed well'.

If you don't have a stated point of view yet, that's worth fixing before this step — a hook pattern applied to no particular opinion just produces a generic version of the same content everyone else in your niche is already making from the same analysis.

What the output actually looks like

A compressed example, so you know what to expect before running it on real data.

Sample finding from Step 1 (analysis)

HOOK PATTERN: 4 of the top 5 posts open with a direct callout naming a specific mistake or belief ("You're pricing this wrong", "Stop doing X"), not a question. Bottom 5 posts mostly open with a general statement about the topic before getting specific.

FORMAT PATTERN: reels outperform carousels 3:1 on average engagement in this sample, but the single highest-performing post overall is a carousel – worth a second look rather than dismissing the format.

NOT WORKING: the 3 lowest posts share a pattern of announcing something (a launch, an offer) as the hook itself, with no standalone value before the ask.

Sample output from Step 2 (ideation)

IDEA 4 – Format: reel – Pattern: direct-callout hook

Hook: "Aapka WhatsApp reply time hi aapka sabse bada lead-loss hai"

Core idea: response-time cost, translated to Sanchit's automation niche

Built on: hook pattern (callout, not question) + not-working pattern (avoid opening with an announcement)

Notice what carried over and what didn't: the structure (callout hook, reel format, leading with value not an ask) transferred. The specific words, the original niche, and the original example did not — that's the difference this whole document is built around.

Where reverse-engineering ends and copying starts

Worth being explicit about, because the line is easy to blur once you're staring at someone else's high-performing hook.

This is reverse-engineering	This is copying
Noticing callout-style hooks outperform questions in this niche	Using their exact hook, word for word, with your product name swapped in
Applying "reel + direct callout + lead with value" as a structure	Recreating their specific example, story, or client anecdote as if it happened to you
Testing whether carousels work better than reels for your audience too	Screenshotting and reposting their carousel slides with your logo added
Learning that this niche's audience responds to a specific number in the hook	Copying their specific number or claim without your own data behind it

A simple test

If you removed the account you analysed from existence, would your idea still make sense as something you'd have made anyway, just informed by better judgement about structure? If yes, you're reverse-engineering. If your idea only exists because you can picture their exact post next to yours, you're copying it.

Patterns aren't ownable. A specific sentence, story, or piece of original writing is. Keep the workflow on the pattern side of that line and it stays both ethical and, honestly, more effective — because your version has your actual expertise in it.

Doing this regularly

One analysis is useful once. A repeatable rhythm is what actually replaces a blank content calendar every month.

A simple system

- 01** Keep a rotating list of 8-12 accounts in or adjacent to your niche — not just direct competitors, include ones in a different niche with a format worth studying.
- 02** Analyse 2-3 accounts per week rather than all of them at once. This keeps each analysis current and keeps the ideation prompt from repeating the same patterns back to you.
- 03** Log which patterns you've already used. If three accounts all show the same callout-hook pattern, that's a strong signal, not a reason to run the same ideation prompt three separate times — collapse it into one round of ideas.
- 04** Track what you actually post against what the analysis suggested, and check back in a month. This is what turns the workflow from a one-off trick into a system you can trust.

The compounding value isn't any single analysis — it's noticing which patterns keep showing up across many accounts over months. That's a far stronger signal than anything one account's data can tell you alone.

Common pitfalls

- Analysing an account that isn't actually a strong performer. A famous account isn't necessarily a well-performing one relative to its size — check engagement rate, not just follower count, before picking your source.
- Too small a sample. Under 15 posts, one viral outlier skews the entire "pattern" — treat any finding from a small sample as a hypothesis to test, not a rule.
- Skipping the "not working" analysis. It's less fun to look at, and it's often the more actionable half — knowing what to avoid narrows your options faster than knowing what to try.
- Letting the ideation prompt drift back toward their voice. If ideas start sounding like the source account instead of you, tighten the tone and point-of-view inputs in Section 04 rather than accepting generic output.
- Treating one account's pattern as universal. A pattern that repeats across 3-4 different accounts in your niche is a real signal. A pattern from one account is just that account.

Offering this as a service

"Competitor content audit" is a genuinely easy sell — it's concrete, it's fast to deliver, and most businesses have never had one done properly.

- 01** Package it as a deliverable, not a process. Clients want the findings and the ideas, not a description of the prompt you used.
- 02** Analyse 3-4 accounts per audit — their own, plus 2-3 real competitors — and show where their current content sits relative to what's actually working in their space.
- 03** Always include the ideation step in the deliverable. Patterns alone are analysis; ideas in the client's voice are the thing they're actually paying for.
- 04** Be upfront about the data-collection method you're using and its limits (see Section 01) — a client who later asks why there's no view-count data on one account deserves an answer you already have ready.

This pairs naturally with a monthly content-production retainer — the audit is the diagnosis; the ongoing work is the treatment.

Sources & notes

Checked August 2026. Instagram's data-access rules and third-party tool landscape change frequently — verify current terms before building a workflow that depends on any one method at volume.

What the guide says	Basis
Business Discovery API lets an authenticated Business/Creator account query another public Business/Creator account's bio, follower/media counts, and recent posts' like/comment counts	Meta Instagram Graph API documentation, cross-checked against multiple independent 2026 developer guides
Business Discovery does not expose reel view counts or reach for other accounts	Same sources — consistently noted as a limitation of this endpoint
Business Discovery requires Facebook Login auth (the older of Instagram's two API auth paths), not the newer Instagram Login path	Instagram API reference documentation, 2026
Instagram's official API does not support reading arbitrary public/personal account data — only Business/Creator accounts, and only a limited field set for accounts you don't own	Multiple independent 2026 Instagram API guides

This document does not provide the technical setup for any third-party scraping tool. That category changes fast and carries platform-specific terms worth checking directly with the provider and against Instagram's current policies before use, especially for client work.

THAT'S THE PROMPT

Steal the structure. Never the sentence.

Every account worth studying already told you what works — it's sitting in the engagement numbers next to each post. The only thing separating that from a content calendar is fifteen minutes of structuring the data and two prompts.

Pick one account today. Pull 20 posts by hand if that's the fastest honest option available to you right now. Run both prompts. You'll have more ideas than you'll use this month.

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If you run this and find a pattern category the prompt missed, send it over — the next version gets sharper from exactly that kind of edge case.

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